



public sector must lead the way.

There are many structured ways for the private sector to contribute, but it must be a collaborative effort. We always focus on adopting technologies that bring greater benefits to our patients. In this, we are ahead of our competitors, and we strive to apply this approach across all the markets we operate in.

Q: What makes the Indian healthcare market lucrative, and what potential do Tier II and III cities hold for growth?

A: Currently, we operate in four metro cities, and Gleneagles is focussing on expanding in southern and western India. For example, we have 900 to 1,000 beds now, but we could easily increase that to 1,500. We have

a major hospital in Chennai, and we're looking to expand further in Tamil Nadu, to places like Coimbatore and Tiruchirappalli. These cities will form a part of our hub-and-spoke model. We are also considering other cities like Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada, which naturally feed into Hyderabad. Expanding into these adjacent clusters makes sense, especially as we're already present in 12 of India's 24 states. Another example is our hospital in Mumbai, where 15% of our patients come from south Gujarat. So, it makes sense to explore expansion in Surat. We have a lot of data on where our patients are coming from, and this helps guide our decisions. In NCR, for example, the patient footfall is significant, and the region continues to grow.

Q: Do you foresee any challenges in the space?

A: Second-tier cities are attractive [but] pose unique challenges for private hospitals. Fortis started hospitals in places like Moradabad, Kangra, Kota, and Raipur. The issue in these cities is that affluent patients often prefer to seek treatment in larger cities... Another challenge is attracting talent. It's difficult to persuade experienced consultants to practice in smaller cities, even if they are originally from there. **The private sector will always rely on a hub-and-spoke model, with secondary hospitals feeding into larger tertiary care facilities.** For example, can you perform a liver transplant in Surat? Probably not, because you need a team of specialised surgeons and support staff. That's a challenge we'll always face. Secondary hospitals can provide basic care, but complex procedures will always need to be performed at larger facilities.

Q: Are you planning to expand to newer markets?

A: We have consolidated our presence in the 10 countries we operate in, but we're considering expansion into Indonesia and Vietnam. Both have significant growth potential, especially in healthcare manpower and spending power, making them attractive markets for us in the future. India remains a core market for us, driven by factors like a large and growing middle and upper-income population, strong insurance penetration, and increasing non-communicable diseases such as diabetes and cancer. Additionally, India has an abundance of clinical manpower, particularly nurses, which is a challenge in other countries. **We aim to remain a Top 3 player in India, based on clinical quality, revenue, and operational efficiency.** BT

@neetu_csharma